

4.10.5. Exchange Message Processing

After completion of [Section 4.7.2, “Message Reception”](#), if the message [matches an existing Exchange](#), it is dispatched to the appropriate protocol handler in the next higher layer. Messages for an existing Exchange are dispatched to the handler for that Exchange. Otherwise, the [unsolicited message](#) that created the Exchange is dispatched to the unsolicited message handler.

4.10.5.1. Exchange Message Matching

Upon receipt of a message, the Exchange Layer attempts to match the message to an existing [Exchange](#). A given message is part of an Exchange if it satisfies all the following criteria:

1. The message was received over the session associated with the Exchange.
2. The Exchange ID of the message matches the Exchange ID of the Exchange,
3. The message has the [I Flag](#) set and the Exchange Role of the Exchange is Responder,
OR the message does not have the [I Flag](#) set and the Exchange Role of the Exchange is Initiator.

If the message does not match an existing Exchange, the message is considered an [unsolicited message](#).

4.10.5.2. Unsolicited Message Processing

An unsolicited message is processed as follows:

1. If the unsolicited message is not marked as having a duplicate message counter, has a registered [Protocol ID](#), and the [I Flag](#) is set:
 - a. Create a [new exchange](#) from the incoming message.
 - b. The new exchange will be used by the upper layer for generating responses and subsequent processing of the message.
2. Otherwise, if the message has the [R Flag](#) set:
 - a. Create an [ephemeral exchange](#) from the incoming message and send an immediate standalone acknowledgement.
 - b. The message SHALL NOT be forwarded to the upper layer, and excluding the sending of an immediate standalone acknowledgment, SHALL be ignored.
 - c. The *ephemeral exchange* created for such duplicate or unknown messages with [R Flag](#) set is automatically closed in [Section 4.12.5.2.2, “Standalone acknowledgement processing”](#).
3. Otherwise, processing of the message SHALL stop.

Creating an Exchange based on an Incoming Message

The steps to create a new Exchange based on an incoming message are as follows:

1. A new Exchange and [Exchange Context](#) SHALL be created with the following settings:
 - a. The Exchange ID SHALL be set to the Exchange ID of the message.
 - b. The Exchange Role SHALL be set to the inverse of the incoming message [I Flag](#), for example set the Exchange Role to Responder if the message is from an Initiator.